

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ 10 9 8 4

♣ 10 8 4 2

♠ Q 10 9 6 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ K J 3

♣ J 6



♠ K 5

♥ Q J 9 7 2

♦ A Q 6

♣ 9 7 3

♠ A J 8 3

♥ 10 6

♦ 7 5 2

♣ A K Q 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♠

2 ♥

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥ Q

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥ Q, dummy played the ♥ 6

Overtake with the ♥ K.

Your side needs to take 5 tricks to defeat this contract. Two of them will be ♥ s, but it doesn't look like you can win any ♣ s or ♠ s.

That means you need to win 3 ♦ tricks and the only way that can happen is if you play ♦ s from your side.

So win the first ♥ K (so partner will know you also have the ♥ A), and play the ♦ 10. Presumably North will play an honor, but East will take the trick and put you back on lead with your ♥ A. You play the ♦ 9 and your side will collect 3 ♦ tricks to go with your 2 ♥ s.

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A K Q 8 6 4

♥ 8

♦ 7 4 2

♣ A J 9

♠ J 3

♥ K Q J 6

♦ A K Q 10 5

♣ 6 2



♠ 10

♥ 7 3 2

♦ 9 8 6 3

♣ Q 7 5 4 3

♠ 9 7 5 2

♥ A 10 9 5 4

♦ J

♣ K 10 8

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

1 ♦

Pass

1 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

Lead: ♠ A

through South's ♣ K at trick 3.

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ A, then the ♠ K. Dummy follows suit and it is your play to the second trick.

Ruff partner's ♠ K.

It is obvious that your side can only get 2 ♠ tricks. And assuming that South has the Ace of trumps you will not make a single trick in the red suits. So you need to make 2 ♣ tricks.

If partner has the ♣ A K then he will take them, but if he has the ♣ A J he cannot win 2 ♣ tricks from his side.

To allow for this situation it will be better to play ♣s from your side of the table, and the way to make that happen is for you to ruff partner's ♠ K with an otherwise useless trump. You still get your two ♠ winners (sort of) but now you get to play a ♣

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 8 3
 ♥ A K 9 7 5
 ♦ Q 9 5
 ♣ 6 3

♠ K Q 6

♥ Q 10 4

♦ J

♣ A J 9 8 4 2



♠ 9 7 5 2

♥ 8 2

♦ 10 7 6 4 3

♣ K 7

♠ A 10 4

♥ J 6 3

♦ A K 8 2

♣ Q 10 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
1 ♥	2 ♣	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♥8			

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥8, dummy played the ♥J

Play the ♥9. North played dummy's ♥J to tempt you to cover. Don't fall for it.

Partner's lead of a high spot card shows no honors in the suit. That added to the fact that North bid Notrump after you had mentioned ♥s is pretty good evidence that North holds at least ♥ Q x x.

To maintain communication with partner your best hope is to duck the first ♥, but to signal encouragement with the ♥9.

North wins the first trick easily, but must try to establish ♣s. He will enter dummy with the ♠A, then try to run the ♣Q.

Not today. Partner takes the ♣K and returns his ♥2 to your four winners.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

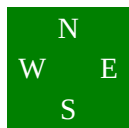
♠ K 6 2
 ♥ 10 6 4
 ♦ A J 6 5 4
 ♣ 9 2

♠ Q J 9 3

♥ K Q J 5

♦ 9 3

♣ Q J 10



♠ 8 4

♥ 9 7 3

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ A 6 5 3

♠ A 10 7 5

♥ A 8 2

♦ K Q

♣ K 8 7 4

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♣9			

wait. Declarer then runs dummy's ♠Q. Partner wins the ♠K, returns his OTHER ♣ to your ♣A, and NOW you give him the ruff. He takes the ♦A for down 1.

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣9, dummy played the ♣10

Play the ♣6.

Partner's ♣9 is likely from a short suit. If it is a singleton, you should take the ♣A immediately and return the suit for a ruff. If it is a doubleton, you should NOT take your ♣A now, but should hope partner can get the lead and play his second ♣ to your Ace so you can give him the ruff.

You can figure out which it is.

If it is a singleton, then South must hold 5 ♣s. But you know South has 4 ♠s, so if he also has 5 ♣s then he only has 4 red cards, and he would not have opened 1NT with either 5-4-2-2 or 5-4-3-1 distribution.

So partner's ♣9 is not a singleton, and you should

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

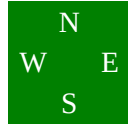
♠ Q J 9 7
 ♥ K Q 6 5 3
 ♦ 10
 ♣ A 6 4

♠ A K 4

♥ A 7 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ Q 5 2



♠ 10 8 3

♥ 10 2

♦ Q J 8 6 4 2

♣ 8 3

♠ 6 5 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ 9 5

♣ K J 10 9 7

West	North	East	South
1♥	Dbl	Pass	2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♥10			

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥10, dummy played the ♥J

Play the ♥6.

Declarer gets two ♥ winners whether you play one of your honors on this trick or not. So why does it matter what you do?

Suppose you cover with your ♥Q. North will win his ♥A, then play ♣s until your ♣A is forced out on the third round. He can then force an entry to dummy in the ♥ suit to reach the two ♣ winners.

Now suppose you duck the ♥J. Again North will push ♣s, and again you hold up until the third round. Ahh, what a difference. Now declarer cannot use the ♥s to enter dummy and he will never get to enjoy those two ♣ winners.